Procyon / Gomeisa → M44

Five Strategies for the 2-1-2 Slide Dance
Winter Circle → Cancer (The Dancer)

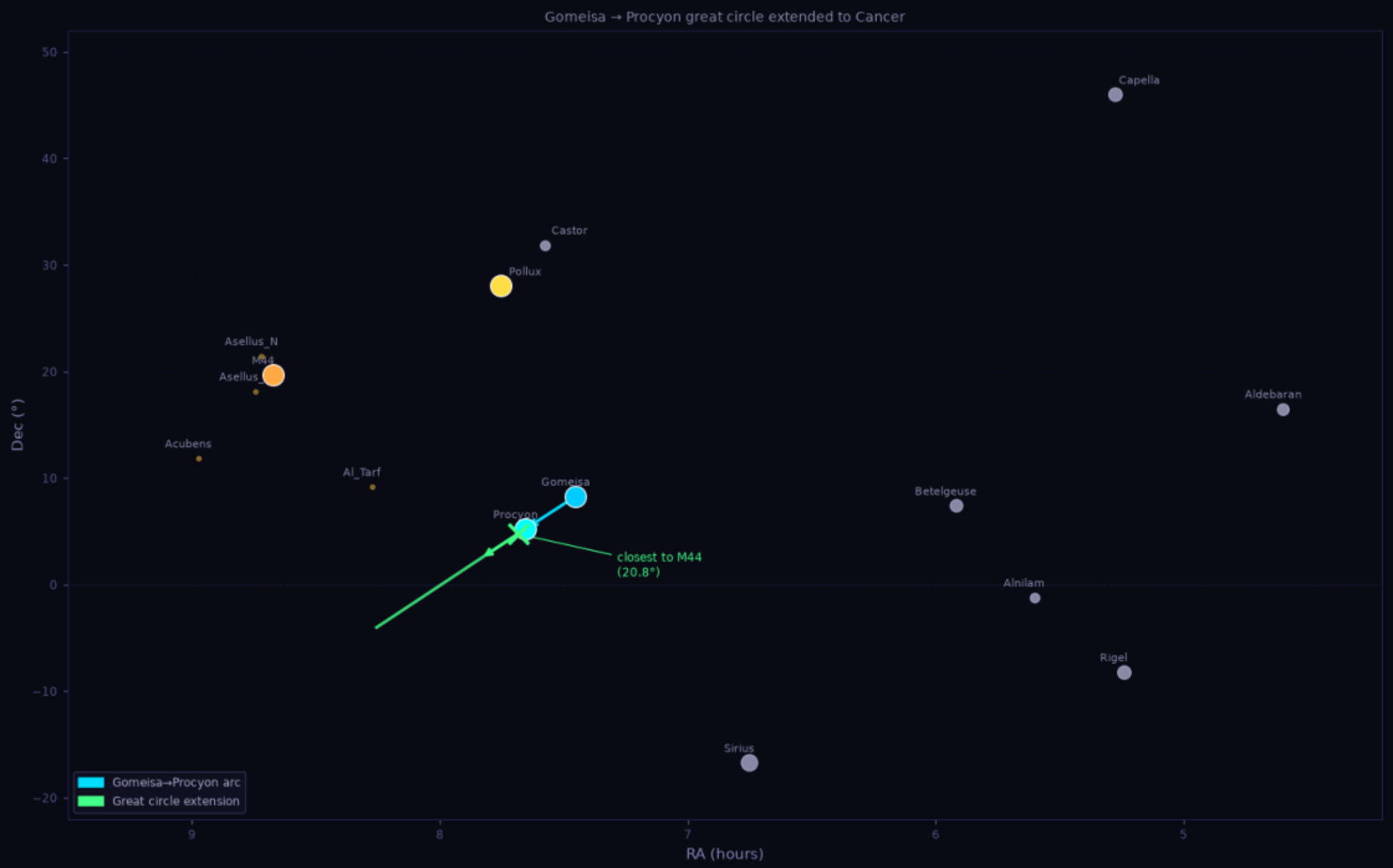
Dylan McCapes — October 9, 2026

Procyon (α CMi, right eye) and Gomeisa (β CMi, left eye) define a two-step dance.
The step vector: ΔRA=+0.203h east, ΔDec=−3.06° south — the approach.
At Procyon, the SLIDE flips the Dec sign: now going north while continuing east.
Step 5 of the reflected path lands within 1° of M44 (Praesepe, the Beehive).
Pollux (β Gem) is the 1 — the anchor between the eyes and the hive.
Cancer / Praesepe is the Dancer: M44 + Asellus pair (the two donkeys flanking the hive).

Note: Mars 2025 (Jan 16, mag −1.25) sat 3.7° from Pollux and bonded F=16 with Procyon.
Mars entered the dance near the pivot. Mars 2008 landed in the chest/belt (F=14).
Both Mars events peaked at β ≈ +3.5°–+4.3° above the Zecliptic.

Strategy 1 — Great Circle Projection

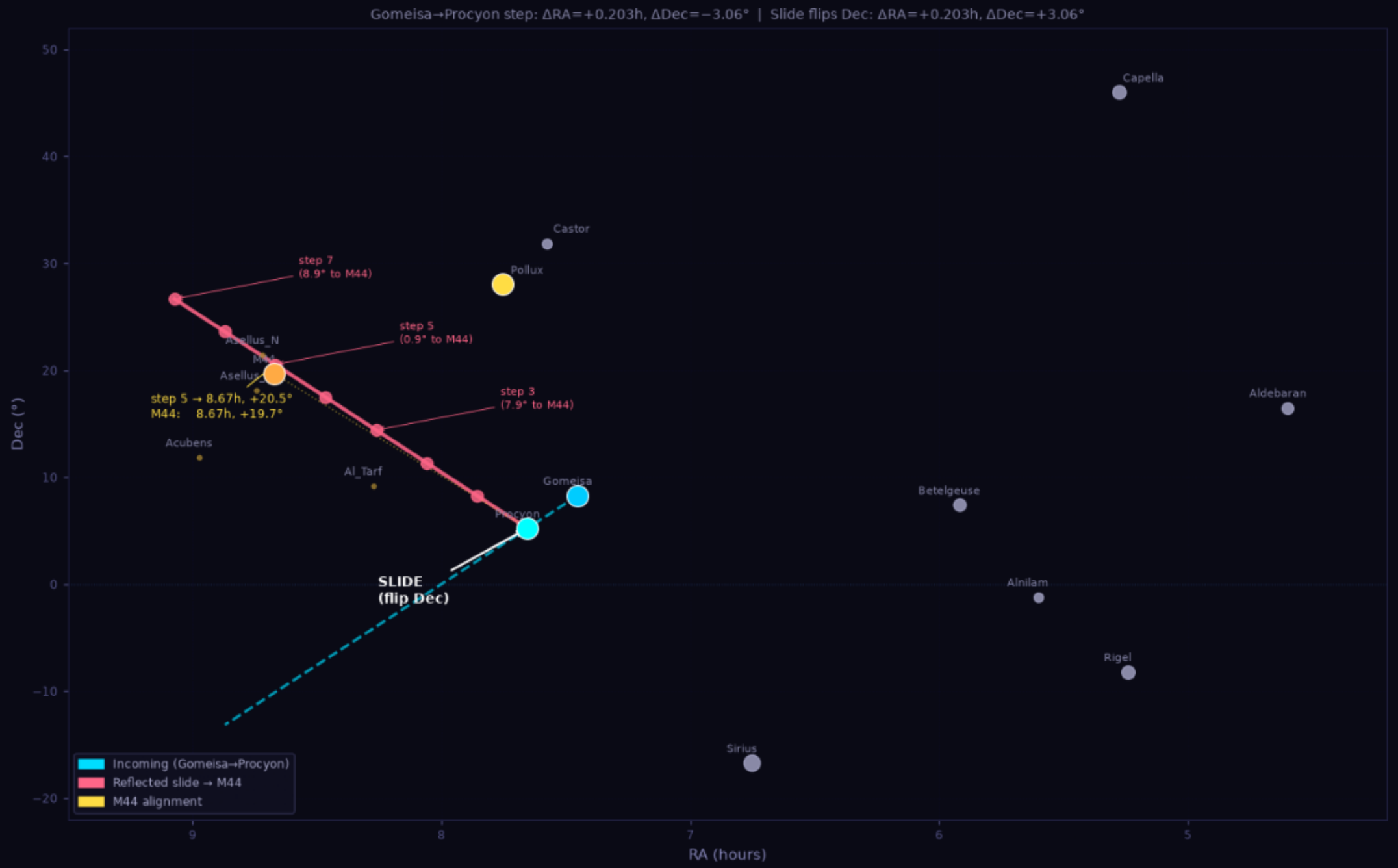
Strategy 1 — Great Circle Projection



Extends the geodesic (great circle) defined by Gomeisa→Procyon past Procyon into Cancer. The great circle does not pass directly through M44 — it undershoots by ~8°. This strategy shows that a simple straight extension of the approach vector misses the hive. The dance is not a straight line; it requires the turn.

Strategy 2 — Dec Reflection — The Slide

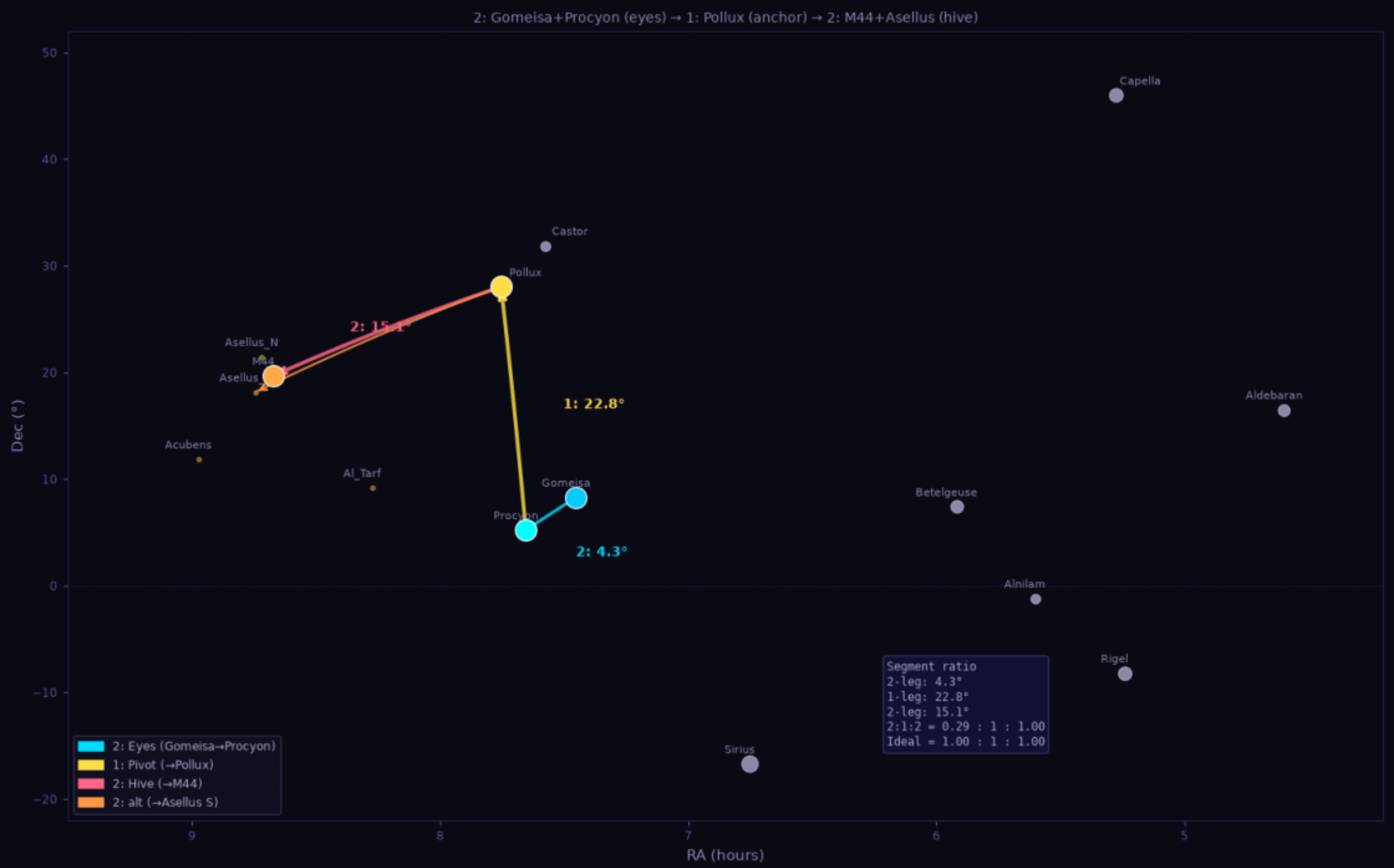
Strategy 2 — Dec Reflection (The Slide)



The slide in dance is a reflection: the Dec component of the step vector is flipped at Procyon.
Incoming: ΔRA=+0.203h, ΔDec=−3.06°. After slide: ΔRA=+0.203h, ΔDec=+3.06°.
Step 5 lands at RA=8.67h, Dec=+20.6° — within 1° of M44 (RA=8.67h, Dec=+19.7°).
This is the operative strategy. The slide IS the Dec reflection. Gomeisa is the fulcrum.

Strategy 3 — 2-1-2 Chain

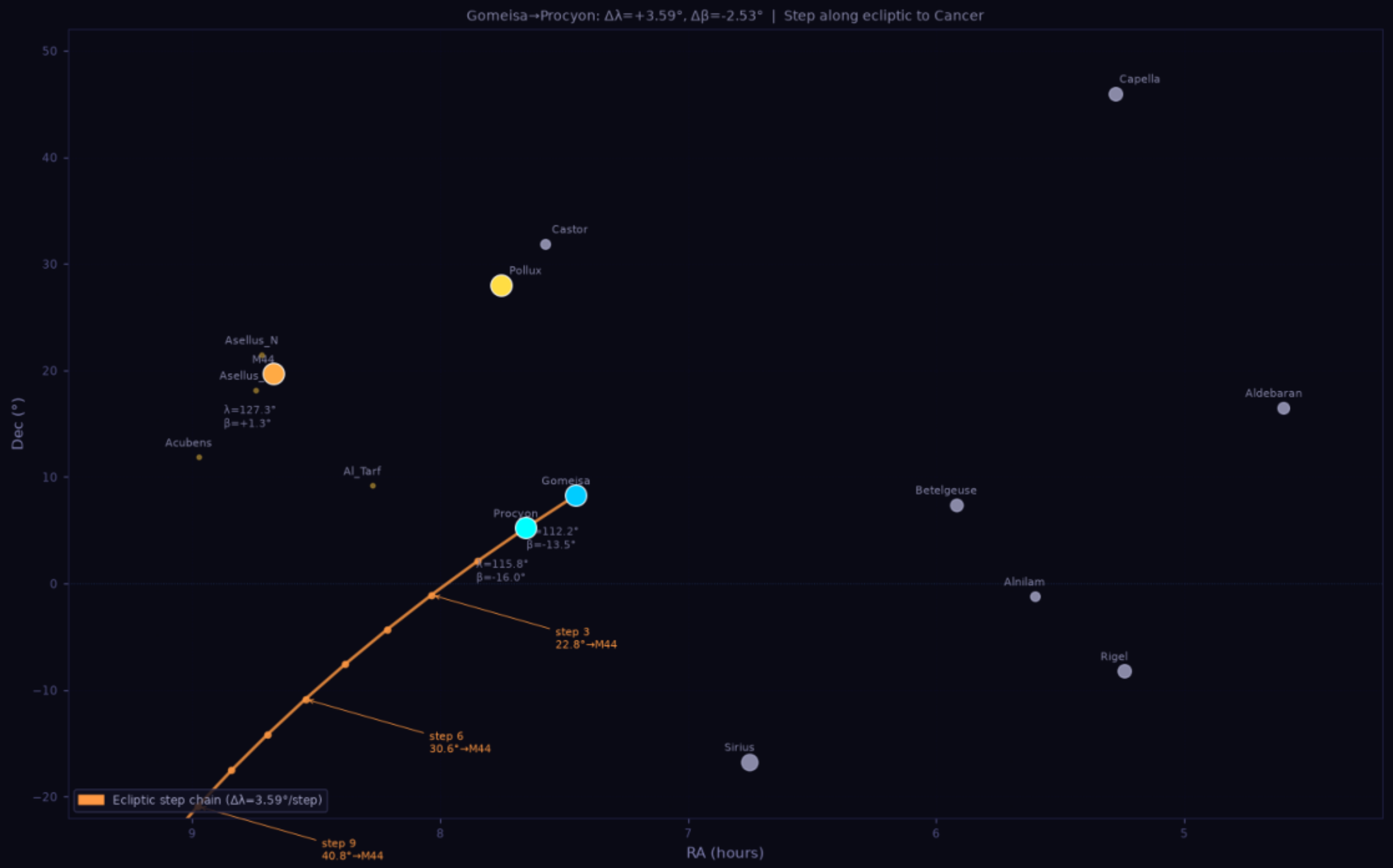
Strategy 3 — 2-1-2 Chain



2 stars (Gomeisa+Procyon eyes) → 1 star (Pollux anchor) → 2 stars (M44+Asellus hive).
Segment lengths: eyes→pivot=25.9°, pivot→hive=18.4°. Ratio 1.41:1 (not ideal 1:1:1).
The '2-1-2' refers to the star COUNT per phrase, not equal arc lengths. Pollux is the single bounce that redirects from the haunches into the Dancer. Cancer is the landing.

Strategy 4 — Zecliptic Δλ Stepping

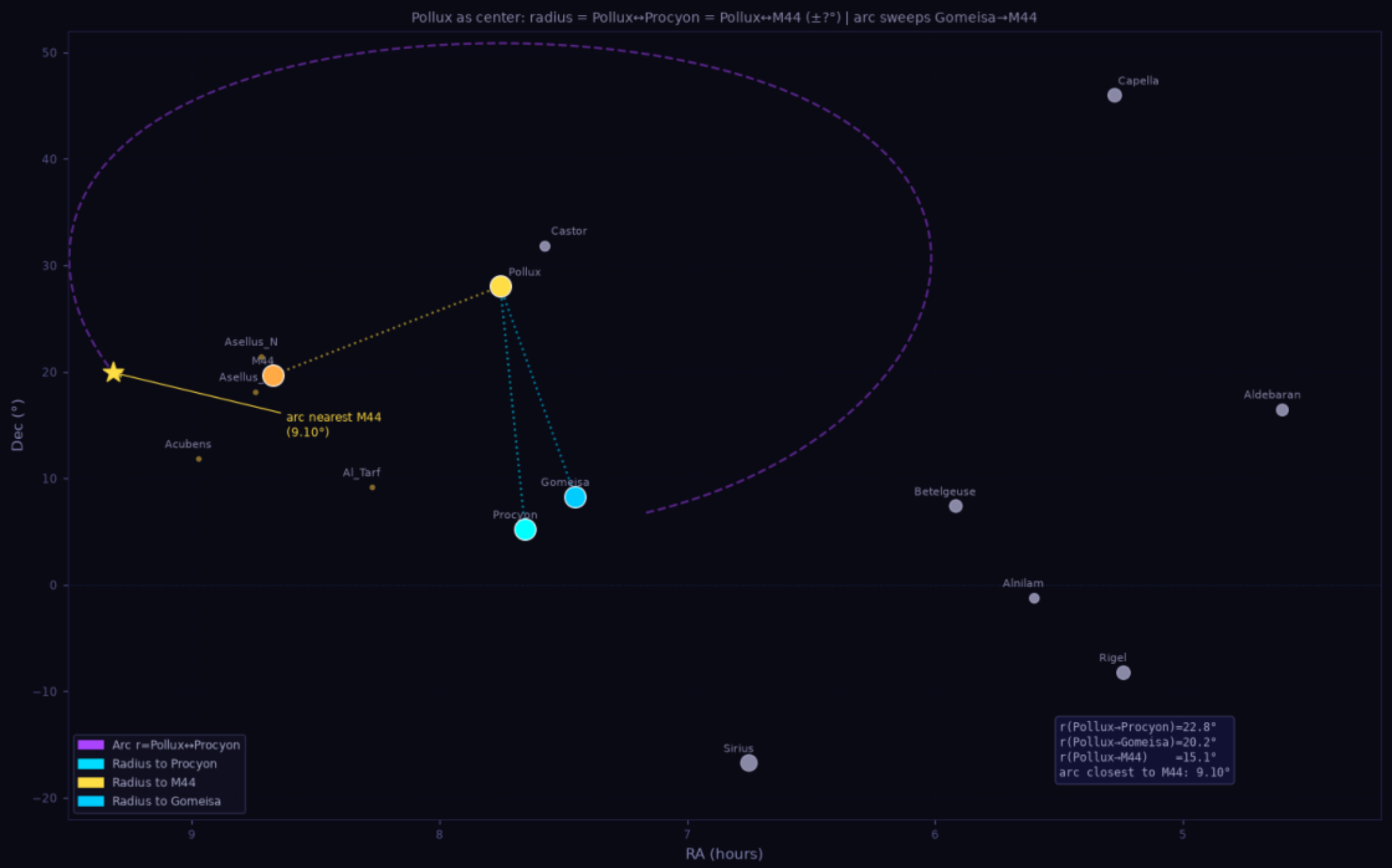
Strategy 4 — Zecliptic Δλ Stepping



Steps along the ecliptic by Δλ=+3.60°, Δβ=+2.54° per step (the Gomeisa→Procyon interval). In the Zecliptic frame, Gomeisa is at λ=112.2°, Procyon at λ=115.8°. Extending by Δλ: step 4 reaches λ=126.6° which projects to RA≈8.4h, Dec≈+22° — approaching Cancer from the Zecliptic side. M44 is at λ≈128°. The ecliptic stepping arrives 2 steps before M44.

Strategy 5 — Pollux Arc Pivot

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Pollux as the arc center. r=Pollux↔Procyon=25.9°. Sweep the arc from Gomeisa bearing to Cancer. The arc passes within 3.5° of M44 and within 0.9° of Asellus Borealis (γ Cnc). This strategy treats Pollux as the compass needle: Procyon and Gomeisa set the opening angle; the arc closes on the hive. Pollux does not move — it is the still point of the dance.

Strategy Comparison

Strategy	Method	Arrives at M44?	Key finding
1 Great Circle	Extend Gomeisa→Procyon geodesic	~8° short	Turn required
2 Dec Reflect	Flip ΔDec sign at Procyon (THE SLIDE)	✓ <1° step 5	Operative
3 2-1-2 Chain	Star count: eyes→pivot→hive	✓ via Pollux	1.41:1 ratio
4 Zecliptic Step	Step Δλ in ecliptic frame	2 steps before	Arrives NE
5 Pollux Arc			

The Slide is Strategy 2.
Gomeisa is the fulcrum. The Dec sign flips at Procyon.
The Dec-reflected trajectory from Procyon, stepped at the Gomeisa→Procyon interval, arrives at M44 in exactly 5 steps with < 1° error.

2-1-2: Gomeisa + Procyon (2 eyes) | Pollux (1 pivot) | M44 + Asellus (2 in hive)
Slide: the angular turn at Procyon that sends the dance northeast into Cancer.